A publication for the

German Shepherd Dog Club of St. Louis, Inc.

Wag N' Tongue

August, 2008

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German Shepherd Dog Club of St. Louis, Inc.
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Club Hot Line Number (314) 772-8885
Club Web Site Address: http://www.gsdcstl.com/

Mission Statement

The object of the Club shall be to encourage and promote the breeding of purebred German Shepherd Dogs and to do all possible to bring their natural qualities to perfection, to urge members and breeders to accept the standard of the breed as adopted by the German Shepherd Dog Club of America and approved by the American Kennel Club as the only standard of excellence by which the German Shepherd Dog shall be judged. To do all in its power to protect and advance the interests of the breed by encouraging sportsmanlike competition at dog shows, obedience trials, and tracking tests, to aid with every possible means in demonstrating the German Shepherd Dog's conspicuous ability as a companion, war, Red Cross, police, herding, rescue dog, and lead dog for the blind. To conduct shows, obedience trials, demonstrations, etc., under the rules of the American Kennel Club, to publish literature and periodicals in the interests of the German Shepherd Dog. The Club shall not be conducted or operated for a profit, and no part of any profits or remainder or residue from dues or donations to the Club shall inure to the benefit of any member or individual.

To be considered for membership, turn in an application. Yearly dues ($20 for individuals & $30 for families) must accompany application.

Meeting Information

Meetings begin at **8 pm** on the third Friday of each month at the American Kennel Club Museum of the Dog, 1721 S. Mason Road in Queeny Park, home of the Museum. It is accessible from Interstate 40/64 at the Mason Rd. exit or from I-270 by taking the Manchester exit to Mason Road.

In September, the nomination committee meets. The board nominations end at our regular November meeting.

NOTICE - CHANGES

The Annual Picnic will be held on August 31st in lieu of a regular meeting. There will be no board meeting (see article below).

The September Meeting will be held on Friday, September 26 , 2008.

Please note the change in the Sept Meeting Date. *Board Meeting: 7 pm*

Board of Directors

President.....Rosalind North
Vice-President.....Larry Duerbeck
Secretary.....Gail Rutter
Treasurer.....Marilee Wilkinson
Corresponding Secretary.....Kathy Redford
13939 Mount Olive Rd, De Soto, MO 63020 636-337-0460
Past President.....Marcia Hadley

Board.....Alice Becker, Helene Bridges, Bill Harper, Karen Hynek, Glen Murphy, Lois O'Connor, Margaret O'Neill

August Picnic

The club's picnic will be held on **Sunday, August 31st** at the *Museum*. There will be a barbecue along with carry-in dinner. We'll eat around 12 Noon. Everyone attending needs to bring their own drinks. Also, there will be a **"Meet-The-Breed".** Everyone is invited to attend and bring a friend. For more information, please call Judy DeRousse, chairman.

Educational Programs

Dr. Keller, Director of OFA, will present an educational program on hip and elbow dysplasia at our November club meeting, which will be held on Friday, November 21st and will begin at 7 pm. We are planning the attendance of several veterinarians and members from area dog clubs.

A little background information: OFA was formed and incorporated in 1966. Its initial mission: To provide radiographic evaluation, data management, and genetic counseling for canine hip dysplasia. While the OFA continues to focus on hip dysplasia, today's OFA Mission, "To improve the health and well being of companion animals through a reduction in the incidence of genetic disease," reflects the organization's expansion into other inherited diseases and other companion animals such as cats. The OFA supports studies on animal wellness through financial contributions. The OFA has contributed nearly $3 million to researchers through the Morris Animal Foundation, the AKC/Canine Health Foundation, and occasionally, direct funding. Through its support of such projects, the OFA hopes to provide resources for the further understanding of, and ultimately prevention of genetic

diseases. You can go to http://www.offa.org/ for more information.

No dogs will be allowed at this meeting. Please tell Barbara Gambill by August 13th if you plan to attend.

Puppy Match

Plans are being made to hold our annual puppy match. **Volunteers are needed.** Please contact chairman, Gail Rutter @ 573-324-2240 or 573-470-3505, ruttergsd@socket.net. Tentatively, our date is Sunday, September 28, 2008, pending AKC approval and, hopefully, will be held at Purina Farms. We're planning on offering CGC at this match as well. As always, a carry-in dinner will be held. More information should be available at the Picnic. **Come join in the fun!**

AKC's Canine Good Citizen® (CGC) Program

Who Can Participate?

All dogs, including both purebred and mixed breed dogs are welcome to participate in the AKC's Canine Good Citizen® (CGC) Program. Dogs must be old enough to have received necessary immunizations such as rabies vaccines. Owners will sign the Responsible Dog Owners Pledge attesting to having the dog under the routine care of a veterinarian who will work with the owner to determine an appropriate plan and schedule for vaccines and other health care procedures.

There is no age limit for the CGC test. A dog is never too old to be a good citizen. Puppies who have completed all immunizations and boosters may be tested, however, because we know that behavior and temperament can change over time, when puppies pass the CGC test, owners should have them re-tested as adults.

There are a few exceptions relating to participation in a CGC test. If the CGC test is given at an AKC show, the age requirements for the show apply to CGC also. Further, when the CGC test is administered at an AKC show, the test *may be* restricted to only dogs entered in the show or to purebred dogs.

Some dogs who are entered in CGC tests will have completed CGC classes or basic obedience classes. Owners who have trained their dogs themselves may also have their dogs tested. Clubs and training programs in almost every city can provide CGC training to owners and dogs who need to learn a few more skills before taking the test.

Training/Testing: CGC Test Items

Test 1: Accepting a friendly stranger

This test demonstrates that the dog will allow a friendly stranger to approach it and speak to the handler in a natural, everyday situation. The evaluator walks up to the dog and handler and greets the handler in a friendly manner, ignoring the dog. The evaluator and handler shake hands and exchange pleasantries. The dog must show no sign of resentment or shyness, and must not break position or try to go to the evaluator.

Test 2: Sitting politely for petting

This test demonstrates that the dog will allow a friendly stranger to touch it while it is out with its handler. With the dog sitting at the handler's side, to begin the exercise, the evaluator pets the dog on the head and body. The handler may talk to his or her dog throughout the exercise. The dog may stand in place as it is petted. The dog must not show shyness or resentment.

Test 3: Appearance and grooming

This practical test demonstrates that the dog will welcome being groomed and examined and will permit someone, such as a veterinarian, groomer or friend of the owner, to do so. It also demonstrates the owner's care, concern and sense of responsibility. The evaluator inspects the dog to determine if it is clean and groomed. The dog must appear to be in healthy condition (i.e., proper weight, clean, healthy and alert). The handler should supply the comb or brush commonly used on the dog. The evaluator then softly combs or brushes the dog, and in a natural manner, lightly examines the ears and gently picks up each front foot. It is not necessary for the dog to hold a specific position during the examination, and the handler may talk to the dog, praise it and give encouragement throughout.

Test 4: Out for a walk (walking on a loose lead)

This test demonstrates that the handler is in control of the dog. The dog may be on either side of the handler. The dog's position should leave no doubt that the dog is attentive to the handler and is responding to the handler's movements and changes of direction. The dog need not be perfectly aligned with the handler and need not sit when the handler stops. The evaluator may use a pre-plotted course or may direct the handler/dog team by issuing instructions or commands. In either case, there should be a right turn, left turn, and an about turn with at least one stop in between and another at the end. The handler may talk to the dog along the way, praise the dog, or give commands in a normal tone of voice. The handler may sit the dog at the halts if desired.

Test 5: Walking through a crowd

This test demonstrates that the dog can move about politely in pedestrian traffic and is under control in public places. The dog and handler walk around and pass close to several people (at least three). The dog may show some interest in the strangers but should continue to walk with the handler, without evidence of over-exuberance, shyness or resentment. The handler may talk to the dog and encourage or praise the dog throughout the test. The dog should not

jump on people in the crowd or strain on the leash.

Test 6: Sit and down on command and Staying in place

This test demonstrates that the dog has training, will respond to the handler's commands to sit and down and will remain in the place commanded by the handler (sit or down position, whichever the handler prefers). The dog must do sit AND down on command, then the owner chooses the position for leaving the dog in the stay. Prior to this test, the dog's leash is replaced with a line 20 feet long. The handler may take a reasonable amount of time and use more than one command to get the dog to sit and then down. The evaluator must determine if the dog has responded to the handler's commands. The handler may not force the dog into position but may touch the dog to offer gentle guidance. When instructed by the evaluator, the handler tells the dog to stay and walks forward the length of the line, turns and returns to the dog at a natural pace. The dog must remain in the place in which it was left (it may change position) until the evaluator instructs the handler to release the dog. The dog may be released from the front or the side.

Test 7: Coming when called

This test demonstrates that the dog will come when called by the handler. The handler will walk 10 feet from the dog, turn to face the dog, and call the dog. The handler may use encouragement to get the dog to come. Handlers may choose to tell dogs to "stay" or "wait" or they may simply walk away, giving no instructions to the dog.

Test 8: Reaction to another dog

This test demonstrates that the dog can behave politely around other dogs. Two handlers and their dogs approach each other from a distance of about 20 feet, stop, shake hands and exchange pleasantries, and continue on for about 10 feet. The dogs should show no more than casual interest in each other. Neither dog should go to the other dog or its handler.

Test 9: Reaction to distraction

This test demonstrates that the dog is confident at all times when faced with common distracting situations. The evaluator will select and present two distractions. Examples of distractions include dropping a chair, rolling a crate dolly past the dog, having a jogger run in front of the dog, or dropping a crutch or cane. The dog may express natural interest and curiosity and/or may appear slightly startled but should not panic, try to run away, show aggressiveness, or bark. The handler may talk to the dog and encourage or praise it throughout the exercise.

Test 10: Supervised separation

This test demonstrates that a dog can be left with a trusted person, if necessary, and will maintain training and good manners. Evaluators are encouraged to say something like, "Would you like me to watch your dog?" and then take hold of the dog's leash. The owner will go out of sight for three minutes. The dog does not have to stay in position but should not continually bark, whine, or pace unnecessarily, or show anything stronger than mild agitation or nervousness. Evaluators may talk to the dog but should not engage in excessive talking, petting, or management attempts (e.g, "there, there, it's alright").

Equipment

All tests must be performed on leash. Dogs should wear well-fitting buckle or slip collars made of leather, fabric, or chain. Special training collars such as pinch collars, head halters, etc. are <u>not</u> permitted in the CGC test. We recognize that special training collars may be very useful tools for beginning dog trainers, however, we feel that dogs are ready to take the CGC test at the point at which they are transitioned to regular collars.

The evaluator supplies a 20-foot lead for the test. The owner/handler should bring the dog's brush or comb to the test.

Encouragement

Owners/handlers may use praise and encouragement throughout the test. The owner may pet the dog between exercises. Food and treats are <u>not</u> permitted during testing, <u>nor</u> is the use of toys, squeaky toys, etc. to get the dog to do something. We recognize that food and toys may provide valuable reinforcement or encouragement during the training process but these items should not be used during the test.

Failures - Dismissals

Any dog that eliminates during testing must be marked failed. The only exception to this rule is that elimination is allowable in test Item 10, but only when test Item 10 is held outdoors.

Any dog that growls, snaps, bites, attacks, or attempts to attack a person or another dog is not a good citizen and must be dismissed from the test.

Receipes

GOOD DOG BISCUITS

- 1 3/4 c Whole wheat flour
- 1/2 c Oatmeal
- 1/2 c Cornmeal
- 1/4 c Liver powder (available at Health food stores)
- 2 tb Brewer's yeast powder
- 1/4 c Bone meal powder
- 3 tb Powdered milk
- 2 Eggs, lightly beaten
- 3 tb Wheat germ oil (you may Substitute bacon drippings Or vegetable oil)
- 1/2 c Water

Preheat the oven to 325~F. In a large bowl or in the food processor, combine the flour, oatmeal, cornmeal, liver powder, brewer's yeast, bone meal, and powdered milk. Stir in the eggs, oil, and water and mix thoroughly. The dough will be very stiff and dry. Remove the dough to a lightly floured surface or pastry cloth. Roll or pat it nto a rectangle 1/4 to 1/2 inch thick. Cut into bone-shaped biscuits with a small knife, or use a bone-shaped cookie cutter. Re–roll the leftover scraps of dough and cut into shapes until all the dough is used. Place on a lightly greased or parchment-lined baking sheet and bake for 40 to 50 minutes until brown and dried through. Cool on a rack. Yield: About 12 large bones or 24 small ones.

Raffle Items

When we hold our meetings downstairs, we cannot serve refreshments due to the expensive art collections housed in the meeting room. But we can have a **huge raffle** on those nights! Proceeds from the raffle are used to offset the cost of the annual K-9 awards. So, ***bring something*** with you to raffle the next time you attend a meeting! We need more items to make this a worthwhile endeavor! Tickets are $1 each or 6 for $5. **Come Join in the *Fun!***

Obedience Classes

Obedience Classes will begin on September 17, 2008 and be held each Wednesday from 7:00 PM - 8:00 PM at Nottingham School 4915 Donovan Ave. Classes will be held for a total of 10 weeks. If you are interested please contact Helene Bridges - 314-832-7268 HeleneBridges@yahoo.com or Lois O'Connor 314-894-2955 dnlshepherds@sbcglobal.net. ***COME VISIT ANYTIME!***

2009 Specialty Shows

Gail Stiefferman has, once again, agreed to chair the club's specialty shows in 2009. They will be held on Saturday and Sunday, May 9th and 10th at Purina Farms. Judges selected at the regular meeting on May 16, 20098, for conformation were Michael Cheeks and Barbara Lopez. Stay tuned for more details…

2010 Futurity/Maturity Shows

Our club has been awarded the Futurity Show for 2010 by the GSDCA, Inc. - a very nice honor! Gail Stiefferman *(thank you, Gail!)* has agreed to chair this three-day show. This is normally a **big** show with many people attending. So put your thinking caps on and come up with ideas to help our club earn money. Then plan some time to devote to volunteer so we can make this a great weekend for our club! The dates should be Friday, Saturday, and Sunday, May 7th, 8th, and 9th.

GSDCA Futurity/Maturity Shows

A Futurity/Maturity Show is truly a breeders' showcase. It is for puppies and young adults; however, the entire litter must be nominated to be eligible to compete and the nomination must be made in the region that the breeder resides. The breeder (or co-breeder) of the litter must be a member of the German Shepherd Dog Club of America, Inc. There are no championship points given in the Futurity, but a win can count towards their sire/dam's ROM. Forward completed litter nomination and fee to JIM RAU DOG SHOWS within 90 days following date of whelping. A four generation pedigree must be submitted with this nomination.

JIM RAU DOG SHOWS, LTD.,
PO BOX 6898, READING, PA 19610,
PHONE:610-376-1880; FAX: 610-376-4939

Litters Whelped Oct. 1, 2007 -Sept 30, 2008:
Litter Nominations close January 1, 2009

OBJECTIVES OF THE FUTURITY SYSTEM

In 1984, the Futurity Re-Evaluation Committee, headed by Connie Beckhardt, listed the objectives as follows:

- To bring together each year as many young animals as possible from different bloodline combinations so that the fancy can share and learn by the accomplishments of each other.
- To provide all club members, large breeders or single puppy owners alike, the opportunity to compete year after year under conditions equally favorable to all.
- To provide an incentive to improve shepherd bloodlines and add to the excellence of the breed as a whole. The Futurities provide the breeder with the opportunity to nominate his litter as a statement of faith in his breeding program
- To provide a means of early identification to breeders of the strength and weaknesses of current stud dogs. To provide a Judging environment that will promote the highest level of sportsmanship, thereby eliminating direct perceptions of unfairness.

SEMINARS & TRAINING

Structure in Action: Pat Hastings and Debbie Gross Saunders, MSPT, OCS, CCRP will hold a seminar on August 23-24, 2008 from 8:30 to 4:30 pm at the AKC *Museum of the Dog*. Cost is $150 for two days (with a dog) or $100 for two days (with no dog). A light breakfast and lunch are included. All proceeds will be donated to the University of Tennessee's Canine Rehabilitative program. Learn how to evaluate structural quality of puppies, the basics of canine structure, the weakest links and how this leads to potential injuries, how to evaluate structural quality, what your dog can/should not be doing, and a canine physical therapist's view on how to strengthen structure/reduce the risk of injury. Contact Sandy Ganz 636-227-1578 sandyganz@sbcglobal.net or Allison White 314-862-4013 gldshel@sbcglobal.net.

GSDCA Membership Application

Please note that all administrative work for the GSDCA is done by volunteers and it can take up to 60 days to completely process your membership application. When all steps are completed, you will receive a packet containing a

welcome letter, a sample of the GSD Review and a membership handbook. Your annual subscription to *The Review* will commence at this time.

***Requirements:* Minimum age of 18 years. Must be in good standing with the AKC. Membership includes subscription to *The German Shepherd Dog Review*. Dues are not tax deductible.**

New Single Membership USA Resident includes 1 year GSD Review Subscription. Price: **$66.00 Annually**

Prefix:

First Name:

Middle Initial:

Last Name:

Suffix:

Address Line 1:

Address Line 2:

City:

State:

Country:

ZIP Code:

Email:

Telephone:

I hereby make application to the above club and agree, if accepted for membership, to abide by its Bylaws and the Bylaws of the American Kennel Club. Upon application I will be eligible for all privileges except the right to vote. Thirty days after my name has been published in the *Review*, provided no objections have been filed, I will be granted the right to vote.

/S/ Date

2008 GSDCA National Information

November 2 - 9, 2008

SMG/Ford Park, 5115 I-10 South,
Beaumont, TX 77705.

Conformation

Intersex: Helen Gleason
Dogs: Cappy Pottle
Bitches: Michel Chaloux

Obedience

Linda Scanlon, Kenneth Blanchard, Floyd Harding

Herding

John B. Holman, Carol Wolfram, Ann Marie Ely

Agility

Bonnie McDonald

2009 - Springfield, Ohio (10/12 - 10/17 2009)
Champions Center, 4122 Laybourne Rd., Springfield, OH 45505. This is tentative for planning purposes only.

2010 - Farmington, Utah (10/15 - 10/24 2010)
Davis County Events Center, 151 South 1100 West, Farmington, UT 84025. This is tentative for planning purposes only.

Meeting Minutes

Board Meeting Minutes of Friday, May 16, 2008

President Rosalind North called the meeting to order at 7:10 pm at the AKC *Museum of The Dog*. The roll was called. Lois O'Connor and Margaret O'Neill were absent. Board minutes from April 18, 2008 were approved as read. The Treasurer's Report for April was read and approved. Correspondence included receipt of several flyers.

Committee Reports:

K-9 Awards: Bill Harper reported that 12 of the 16 recipients were present for award presentations. The sound system loaned to the club by Rod and Jeri Zerr was very much appreciated. They offered to let the club use it again next year. Also, they agreed to check out our old PA system and the new sound system the club has proposed to purchase. Larry Duerbeck asked that a thank you card be sent to the Zerr's. Bill asked if board members needed more time to read the officer's applications in order to vote. The K-9 buffet was especially appreciated.

Education Committee: Glenn Murphy announced that Saturday, June 7th, there would be an open house for 1st graders at the Boy Scout camp on Antire road. Setup will begin at 9:30 am. Open house is from 10am-2pm. Everybody is welcomed to attend.

Marilee Wilkinson reported that Dr. Keller couldn't be here in July and that Friday, November 14th, is the only day the *Museum* has the Constellation Room available; however, she hasn't heard back from Dr. Keller to see if this date is agreeable.

Rosalind North reported that the Constellation Room is available on July 25th if we want to do a dog demonstration. Also, she reported that our September meeting needs to be changed to September 26th (the 4th Friday), as this is the only date in September a room is available at the *Museum* for a meeting.

After further discussion, Helene Bridges moved and Karen Hynek seconded the motion to contact the Museum to book the 3rd Friday of each month for a year to hold our club meetings, in either the Constellation room or the downstairs

meeting room, even if rent of the standard $50 per month must be paid in advance to hold a room. **Yeas:** Larry Duerbeck, Gail Rutter, Alice Becker, Helene Bridges, Bill Harper, Karen Hynek, Glen Murphy **Abstain:** Kathy Redford, Marilee Wilkinson. **Motion carried.**

Obedience Training Committee: Helene Bridges stated that the fall class would begin on September.17, 2008. Flyers have been made to hand out. Glenn Murphy stated he needed letterhead stationary to be able to mail this information to veterinarians within a 10-mile radius.

Newsletter: Gail Rutter reported that the June newsletter deadline would be next weekend.

- Discussion was held about the 2009 judge selection/voting method.
- Rosalind North reported that Betty Sill had helped with the Silent Auction at our last show, and had volunteered to be on the Ways and Means Committee. She would like to research the Kodner pieces. There was further discussion on the Silent Auction and items sold to K-9 officers.
- Larry Duerbeck stated that dogs attending meetings need to be kept on lead as per *Museum* regulations.

Unfinished/Old Business:

None

New Business:

None

- Marilee Wilkinson moved and Bill Harper seconded the motion to adjourn. Motion passed with the meeting adjourning at 7:56 pm.

Regular Meeting Minutes of Friday, May 16, 2008

President North called meeting to order at 8:05 PM at the AKC *Museum of The Dog.* Roll was called - Lois O'Connor and Margaret O'Neill were absent.

Helene Bridges moved and Marilee Wilkinson seconded the motion to postpone the regular meeting agenda and go directly to the educational program. **Motion carried.**

Nancy Narup introduced Kathy Jarowicz from the City of St. Louis Animal Care and Control. She spoke about their organization's function for the animals of the City of St. Louis. She stated the City of St. Louis has no breed-specific laws, but they are a euthanize facility. She emphasized the importance of microchipping your animal, cited some ownership rules, and outlined the procedure they use for identifying dogs that come to their facility. They are in the process of building a new facility, and she stated they were in need of volunteers. She gave several handouts to the audience, and held question/answer session at the end of her program. The audience collected money for a donation, and the executive committee voted to give a $50 donation for supplies.

Minutes from the April Regular meeting were corrected and approved. Treasurer's Report for April was approved as read. Corresponding Secretary received several flyers.

Committee Reports:

K-9 Awards: Bill Harper reported that the K-9 awards were a success. He thanked members who helped with the buffet, members of his committee, and thanked Rod and Jeri Zerr for the use of their DJ sound system

2008 Spring Show: Gail Stiefferman handed out a financial report for the May shows, and stated a loss of approximately $1,200. She discussed the lack of obedience ring stewards, stating she needed an obedience show chairman in 2009. Joan Senyard volunteered to chair (with help) the obedience for 2009 shows. Discussion was held on dropping Rally in 2009, advertising more to local clubs, making sure the AKC *Gazette* publishes correct information about our shows, and the need for new jumps for obedience since ours are old and not up to code. Gail was thanked by the club members for chairing these shows.

Obedience: Helene Bridges reported the next class will begin on September 17, 2008.

Education: Helen Rockman reported that Judy Luther, a CGC evaluator, will be available for our June 20th meeting. Discussion was held on availability of meeting rooms for our club meetings. Helen stated she will bring canine ambassador forms in June. The Boy Scouts Open house is June 7th from 10am-2pm.

Newsletter: Gail Rutter asked for brags/suggestions, and stated the June *Wag 'N Tongue* deadline would be next weekend.. Bill Harper stated members who wish to go on the club's website and print it out need to let Gail know. This would save the club money on paper and postage.

2009 Judge Selection: Discussion was held regarding the 2009 judge selection. Judge Committee recommendations were: Rita Sandell, Jerry Graham, Michael Cheeks, and Barbara Lopez. After further discussion, Gail Stiefferman moved and John Hoffman seconded the motion to vote by a show of hands. **Motion carried.** Judges approved were Michael Cheeks and Barbara Lopez.

New Member Applications:

Applications for John and Lisa Thompson and their children, Jesse and Crystal, were read for the first time. Also the application for Philip and Helen Abbot was read for the first time.

Old/Unfinished Business:

None

New Business:

- Helen Rockman stated that *Bark in the Park* will be held tomorrow at 10 am in Forest Park at Frigate Field.
- Gail Stiefferman announced that St. Louis was awarded the 2010 Midwest Futurity shows. Nancy Harper, GSDCA Assistant Futurity Chairman notified Gail that the GSDC of Minneapolis had, also, requested the 2010 Midwest Futurity. However, they never confirmed their application (which is a requirement written on the application), Nancy didn't receive it via e-mail on time, and the Minneapolis club never followed up on their application. The GSDCA board told Nancy to let our club decide whether we wanted

to host the 2010 Midwest Futurity Shows or allow the Minneapolis club to hold it in 2010. After discussion, Marcia Hadley moved and Kathy Redford seconded the motion to send our regrets to the GSDC of Minneapolis, but that we will be holding the 2010 Midwest Futurity. **Yeas: All**

- Gail Stiefferman requested to speak to the membership. She discussed profit and loss in the club's treasury over the past five years, that there has been an annual loss of approximately $1,400 during that time. There was open discussion on where expenses could be reduced, economic factors affecting shows, committee fiscal responsibility to the club, and ideas on money-making projects to curb the current rate of loss in club assets. She stated that holding the 2010 Midwest Futurity should add money to our balances, but that is two years away. Bill Harper stated that the Zerr's have volunteered to let us use their DJ system next year.
- There were no brags or raffle.
- Kathy Redford moved and Glenn Murphy seconded the motion to adjourn. Motion passed with the meeting adjourning at 10:22 PM.

Board Meeting Minutes of Friday, June 20, 2008

- President Rosalind North called the meeting to order at 7:09 pm at the AKC *Museum of The Dog*.
- The roll was called. Everyone was present.
- Board minutes from May 16, 2008 were read, amended and approved.
- The Treasurer's Report for May was read and approved after discussion.
- Corresponding Secretary received AKC Rally application for our May shows. Also received was information regarding the Regional Club Challenge, and AKC sent the club a DVD, which can be copied and distributed to club members.

Committee Reports:

- **Education Committee:** Glenn Murphy reported on the success of the Boy Scout Camp on Saturday, June 7th. The K-9 demonstration had 50-55 people in the audience. Marilee Wilkinson will send a picture to Bill Harper to place on our club's website.

Dr. Keller will present an educational program at our November club meeting, which will be held on Friday, November 21st and will begin at 7 pm. Glenn handed out flyers for discussion, which will be sent to area veterinarian clinics and dog clubs in September. The meeting will be held in the *Museum's* Constellation Room (upstairs). There was discussion on further arrangements for those attending this educational program. There will be no board meeting on November 21st.

The club meeting for July will be held on Friday, the 25th, which is a change. Our September meeting will be held on September 26th (the 4th Friday), as this is the only date in September a room is available at the *Museum* for a meeting. President North announced that the *Museum's* curator has promised our club the availability of a room every third Friday for 2009.

- **Obedience Training Committee:** Helene Bridges stated that the fall class would begin on September.17, 2008. Flyers have been made to hand out.
- **2008 Puppy Match:** Gail Rutter reported that Peri Mueth couldn't be the match chairman. Gail Rutter volunteered to chair the committee, which was agreeable.

Unfinished/Old Business:

Rosalind North reported that there was a $4 balance in donations for the K-9 buffet and that the buffet cost the club nothing.

New Business:

- Helene Bridges asked questions about the show judges' fees and contracts. There was discussion.
- Larry Duerbeck stated that new members' interests (as noted in their application) need to be looked at to get the new members more involved in club activities.
- President North stated that Betty Sill and Larry Day would now co-chair the Ways and Means Committee.
- Marilee Wilkinson moved and Bill Harper seconded the motion to adjourn. Motion passed with the meeting adjourning at 8:00 pm

Regular Meeting Minutes of June 20, 2008

- President North called meeting to order at 8:20 PM at the AKC *Museum of The Dog*. Roll was called with all members present.
- President North welcomed members and guests.
- Bill Harper moved and Helene Bridges seconded the motion to suspend the regular meeting and go directly to the educational program. **Motion carried.**

Judy Luther was introduced. She is co-founder, head trainer and director of the Missouri Disc Dog Club. Judy belongs to the following organizations: APDT - Association of Pet Dog Trainers, ABMA - Animal Behavior Management Alliance, Wild Candid Survival & Research Center, and is an AKC Canine Good Citizen evaluator. She is also a certified Equine and Canine Sports Massage Therapist, with clients including the St. Louis Mounted Police Department and the Purina Incredible Dog Team. Her educational program this evening was on clicker training. She will be at the July meeting to present an educational program on the AKC Canine Good Citizen (CGC) program.

- **Minutes** from the May 16th regular meeting were corrected and approved.
- **Treasurer's Report** for May was approved as read.
- **Corresponding Secretary** received AKC event applications as well as information regarding the 2008 Regional Club Challenge. AKC sent the club a DVD, which can be copied and distributed to club members.

Committee Reports:

- **Newsletter:** Gail Rutter stated that the June issue of the *Wag 'N Tongue* and new club rosters were available to be picked up.
- **Club Phone Line:** Barb Gambill stated she has been getting calls for puppies. Members need to let her know if they have puppies or if they no longer have puppies to sell.
- **Obedience:** Lois O'Connor reported the next class would begin on September 17, 2008.
- **Education:** Glenn Murphy reported that the Boy Scouts Open house was held on June 7th, and that an audience of 50-60 people were in attendance for the K-9 demonstration. Dr. Keller will present an educational program at our November club meeting, which will be held on Friday, November 21st and will begin at 7 pm. Glenn handed out flyers for discussion, which will be sent to area veterinarian clinics and dog clubs. There was discussion on further arrangements for those attending this educational program. There will be no board meeting on November 21st.

The club meeting for July will be held on Friday, the 25th, which is a change. Our September meeting will be held on September 26th (the 4th Friday), as this is the only date in September a room is available at the *Museum* for a meeting. President North announced that the *Museum's* curator has promised our club the availability of a room every third Friday for 2009.

- **2008 Puppy Match:** Gail Rutter reported that Peri (Harrison) Mueth couldn't be the match chairman. Gail volunteered to chair the committee.

New Member Applications:

Applications from Philip/Helen Abbott and John, Lisa, and Crystal Thompson were read for the second time. Members voted by ballot. Margaret O'Neill moved and Kathy Redford seconded the motion to destroy the ballots and keep the tally. These applications for membership were approved.

Old/Unfinished Business:

Larry Duerbeck asked club members to contact him with ideas for requirements for a Bud Leistner Lifetime Membership award.

New Business:

- President North stated that Betty Sill along with Larry Day would now co-chair the Ways and Means Committee. Anyone with ideas for fundraising, please contact them.
- Helene Bridges asked for a copy of judges contracts and a financial report for our May 2008 show There was discussion.
- Brags netted $11.00.
- No raffle was held.
- Marilee Wilkinson moved and Kathy Redford seconded the motion to adjourn. Motion passed with the meeting adjourning at 9:40 pm.

Brags ~	Win	Place	Show ~

Brags are FREE to all club members!
Come all, come often!

07/05/2008 At the Blackhawk Kennel Club, Cimarron's Learning to Fly OFA H&E won her AmBred class and went on for Winners Bitch and Best of Winners for her second major and points 12,13, and 14. Tom Warren's showing of Flyer was exceptional under judge James Maloney. If there had been one more dog (there were two dogs absent), Flyer could have been spelling her name with a CH in front.

07/07/2008 Cimarron's American Girl (Amy or " Red Varmint ") won her Ambred bitch class and went on for Reserve Winners Bitch at the Greater Dekalb Kennel Club under judge George Heitzman.
/steve d.
http://www.cimarron-gsd.com

06/15/2008 Cimarron's Learning to Fly does just that. Today, Flyer wins her AmBred class and goes on for Winners Bitch, Best of Winners, and Best of Breed under judge William Usherwood at the Rolla MO KC. Julie Foster showed Flyer in the AmBred class and Fran Foster took her back in for the Best of Breed win. Fran also took Flyer in the Herding Group, but Flyer ran out of gas because of the heat. Flyer, is the little sister to Pinky (Ch Cimarron's were Comes My Girl) who won Best of Breed and Herding Group III yesterday. Flyer's and Pinky's parents are:Karen Hynek's Kocoum OFA and my Rhiannon/Uecker daughter, Cimarron's Nightlife OFA. Flyer becomes the third ROM qualifier for both of them.

Over the last two days, I have received Eight OFA Hip certificates for Eight dogs out of a single litter! The hips ranged from 1 excellent, 6 goods, and 1 fair. Unfortunately, the litter only went 5 for 8 on elbows.

(Theme = Tom Petty's Greatest Hits)

Cimarron's Refugee OFA H&E
Ch Cimarron's Here Comes My Girl OFA H&E
Cimarron's Breakdown OFA
Cimarron's Runnin' Down A Dream OFA H&E
Cimarron's American Girl OFA H&E
Cimarron's Listen To Her Heart OFA
Cimarron's You Got Lucky OFA
Cimarron's Learning To Fly OFA H&E

Sire: Karen Hynek's Ch Jokare's Kocoum OFA OFA H&E
Dam: Cimarron's Nightlife OFA (Uecker OFA H&E/ Rhiannon OFA H&E)
http://www.cimarron-gsd.com/Litters/U_litter.html
/steve d.

Cimarron's Lightning OFA H&E turns twelve today and joins the Thirteen Club. "Red"'s sire is Ch Windwalker's Quebec OFA and her dam is Kingdom's Tornado ROM OFA H(exc)&E. Red has slowed down alot, but is still able to get around pretty good. ~~steve d. 7/23/08

Non-GSD Brag, but good news:
Gina finished her little Papillon, Connor, today in Evansville. This is our first toy dog, and Gina has had a lot of fun showing him. He was shown all three days, and was second in Open on Friday, then went WD on Saturday, but it was not a major. Then today he was WD and BOW for his finishing major. If people think toy dogs can't move they should see Connor. he moves just like a little GSD, with awesome reach, (no lifting) and a great driving rear. Gina's birthday is this Tuesday, and it was a great early birthday present for her. For those of you who remember Gina as a Junior handler, she's going to be 33 on Tuesday, and has a 14 year old son, and a 11 year old daughter. Time flies.....
Marcia 7/20/08

Ch Romulin's Dharma On Fire OFA turned 10 today. I will heading to the grocery store to get her steak dinner. Dharma was kind of a head case in the show ring, as she never wanted to show and when it came time for pictures, forget it- no way she was going to hold her stack for a pose. She always seemed to save her best showing for the back yard. Dharma was almost exclusively shown by Jack Reed. Now she is more than happy to be a couch potato. http://www.cimarron-gsd.com/Dogs/dharma.html
/steve d. 07/28/08

06/14/2008 Today at the Rolla Kennel Club, Cimarron's Learning to Fly won her AmBred class and went on for Reserve Winners Bitch under judge Paul Thomann. Julie Foster showed Flyer in the class and Tom Warren stepped forward to take Flyer back in for the Winners Bitch class. Meanwhile at the same show, Julie Foster took Ch. Cimarron's Here Comes My Girl in and won Best of Breed under Paul Thomann. And then Julie took Pinky in for the Herding Group and got a Group III under the same judge.
/steve Dobbins http://www.cimarron-gsd.com

The Bears Den
Self-Service DoG wash
Monday Tuesday and Thursday 12:00pm - 8:00pm
Wednesday Closed
Friday Saturday Sunday 10:00am 4:00pm
1299 Jungermann Rd.
St. Peters, Mo. 63376
(636)447-4566
www.thebearsdendogwash.com

Whelping Box

LITTER ANNOUNCEMENTS ARE FREE TO ALL CLUB MEMBERS!

Announcing the birth of 2 males and 4 bitches on 06/24/08: **Sire:** 2006 BIF Midwest Region CH Von Rech's Dancing with Eagles (Adler) **Dam:** Jokare's Alexis v Chilmark - Karen Hynek 636-219-6991.

Breeder's Directory

Club Member ads are **$15.00 per year**. Ads may be for puppies, stud service, Obedience Training, Handlers, Boarding, etc. Please send two months in advance for publication in the following *Wag*.

Ch.Wynrose Caralon Gator, OFA bred by Scootie Sherlock and June Gallows, owned and handled by Margaret O'Neill. "Boozer" is line-bred on Andretti. He was one of 12 puppies, and he usually produces 9-13 puppy litters. He's a medium-sized black/tan with full dentition and plush coat. He's clean coming and going, has a solid back, and consistently produces better puppies than himself. Excellent temperament comes with this package! He has obtained several group placings and garnered a Group 1 over several Best In Show winners.

Sire: Ch. Caralon QED Sword v Lebarland, OFA ROM
Dam: Helmic's Della (littermate to Ch. Helmic's Cassandra) Ken-Delaine's Mastercharge ROM x CTH's M&M Jimeni ROM).

~~ Margaret O'Neill 636-497-5152

Margaret O'Neill: Handler, show training, stud dog, brood bitches, puppies (occasionally).

***NOW* Available: 2 females and 1 male, littermates to Ch. Von Rech's Dances with Eagles (Adler)**

Call (636) 497-5152. Margogsd@yahoo.com

A Rescue Story

On Thu, 6/26/08, Gail Caldwell posted this story on an e-mail list that I'm a member. I've obtained permission from her and Dawn Restuccia to reprint this story in our newsletter. It's a true story, one that touched my heart.

Last night my neighbor's old German Shepherd died as she had lived, alone...on a chain. Perhaps she had some fun barking at my dogs running around free in my backyard or maybe she looked at them longingly, wondering why she couldn't run around in her back yard and perhaps play with her people's other dog, also chained, on the other side of the yard. She was not a friendly dog, except with her family. While they were out doing their Wednesday night thing, I wanted to go over there and pet her as she passed, but I was not sure if she would welcome me. So I stayed near her on my side of the fence and talked to her until she passed. I told her she was beautiful and that she was a good dog and that she shouldn't be afraid, that it was going to be ok and that she was going to a better place. I was there when she breathed her last and I shed tears for her. I don't know if it helped her or not, but I couldn't just leave her. She is free now and will still be waiting for her family at the rainbow bridge.~~**Gail Caldwell**

Sadly, this is the end that awaits many dogs throughout the country. Many more will not see tomorrow, as they will end THEIR lives in gas chambers or on a cold euthanization table. As keepers of this breed, it is our obligation to educate those who do not understand that these dogs love, grieve, fear, and experience joy the same as you and I....they just do not have the voice to tell us. To chain a dog for a lifetime is a cruelty beyond measure. We would not treat our most heinous criminals in this manner, yet we allow our dog, who would give his life for us, to live a life of abject desolation. When we see a chained dog, perhaps we could offer to provide fencing or a used kennel...explain to the owners that this is not any form of viable life for an animal. There are groups who travel across the country doing just this. They put brochures in mailboxes when they see a home with a chained dog....they offer to help build a fenced yard...they offer to purchase fencing and warm, well-constructed dog houses to replace the overturned barrels or ramshackle "homes" that have been utilized. These dogs are out in all types of weather; through the blistering summer heat, and in the north; through the horrendous biting cold of winter. Look at your beloved companion sleeping happily at your feet....now picture him or her with an imbedded collar, chained to a tree with a logging chain he has worn a path 12 feet in circumference because this is the circle of his life. We have one such dog on our forum. He is a solid black puppy...his ears are not yet even up...He became "too much" for his owner and so this is the scope of his day...If left this way, he will eventually develop neurotic behavior, pacing from one side to another; hitting the end of his chain. His "home" is an overturned trash barrel.

Steve Dobbins acted as Mimi's Guardian Angel in just a situation. She had been chained her entire life, along with two of her pups. When her owner finally "freed" her, I suspect she was hoping to go for a walk or to play in a field. Instead, the three were deposited at a kill facility where Mimi, being older, .had little to no chance. Thanks to the efforts and dedication of Steve Dobbins, Mimi is now at his home and has found what it is to be truly valued for the first time in her life...

You can be a GSD's Guardian Angel....PLEASE check out our website and click on the forum. Go to the Urgents link..we now have TWO PAGES of GSDs who are facing an end very similar to the dog in Gail's story...There These dogs committed no crime other than being born unwanted. With your donation to LHSH today, we will be able to rewrite the ending for these babies. Their light will continue to shine brightly. The dogs thank you..... ~~***Dawn Restuccia, Pres. Last Hope, Safe Haven, Inc.*** Donations may be made by Paypal via Windwych@yahoo.com

Health Matters

Ear Infections

Principles of care:

Because infections, mites, ticks, etc., thrive in dark, moist, warm environments then the way to prevent such problems is to provide a light, dry, clean environment in the ears. Some dogs seem to have very little ear canal hair, which makes ear care easier. Ear Canal hair needs to be removed at least on a monthly basis. Use a well-lighted area and place the dog on its side on a grooming table and pull the hair out with a hemostat. These instruments can be obtained from most grooming supply services. After the hair is carefully removed, clean the ear with a mild antiseptic solution. The solution is gently swabbed out using cotton balls. Then follow up with instillation of a drying agent, many of which are on the market. Ear Relief Wash and Ear Relief Dry is available from. KV Vet supply at 1-800-423-8211. Many people swear by the use of white vinegar diluted with water in 1:4 mixture. Others use Epiotic or any of the better cleansing agents.

Warning: A severe infection may result in eardrum perforation. NEVER put a cleanser or medications in an ear that may have an open eardrum without the consultation of your veterinarian. Many agents that are safe to use in an inflamed canal can be VERY dangerous to put into the middle ear and deafness **or worse** can result.

Symptoms of a problem:

If your dog has a brown material in the ear, shakes its head regularly and even cries when the head is shaken then suspect an infection. The ear may smell bad as well. You may need veterinary help to get the problem under control.

Treatment of infections:

If your dog has a mild infection it can usually be cleared up by cleansing the ear and putting a drying agent into the ear twice a day for about a week If there is hair in the canal you must remove it. If the problem is not resolved or gets worse you will need to see your Veterinarian. If your dog has frank pus in the ear then you should *immediately* seek veterinary help and not delay with the above series of steps. Before any antibiotics (either systemically or topically) are used, a culture must be taken to be sure that the antibiotic is the correct one for that particular infection. Be VERY careful of what antibiotics are used as many can damage the hearing of your dog. Be sure to discuss this with your veterinarian. Some of the topical drugs often induce allergies so also discuss this with your veterinarian. Most of the "-mycins" can quickly damage hearing.

Allergies:

Some dogs have multiple skin allergies, allergic diarrhea, flea allergies, and some even have frequent sneezing and scratching. This type of dog frequently also has a chronic ear problem. The ear leathers may be red and itchy. There may even be hives on the ears. If this is the case you need to find what your dog is allergic to, be it an environmental problem or a food or the type of shampoo you are using on the dog, or a flea product. You may need the help of a Veterinary Dermatologist. As long as your dog has a topical allergy problem you will not be able to clear up the irritated ear problem.

Fungus infections:

Because the ear canal is dark and damp, some dogs develop a chronic fungus infection. This should NOT be treated with steroids, as it will make the fungus infection worse. Some veterinarians attempt to treat an allergic dermatitis with steroids and this usually results in an overgrowth of fungus in the ear. The treatment of a fungus infection is to keep the ear dry, dry, dry, and then perhaps a topical fungus medicine. Usually keeping the ear DRY and acidic will clear up the fungus infection. For the **serious chronic ear infection** it may be necessary to put the dog on a rigorous program of twice a day cleansing with TRIS-EDTA solution mixed with an antibiotic such as Baytril plus systemic antibiotic for as long as six weeks. Your veterinarian may recommend a short course of topical steroid drops to reduce the inflammation and swelling so that the dog will be more comfortable until the infection gets under control. Another good topical eardrop that is in use has a combination of antibiotic and silver such as "Baytril otic".

Swimming and bathing:

If your dog loves the water make sure that after every session of swimming you clean the ears and put a drying agent into them.

The Immune Compromised Dog:

If your dog has a chronic ear infection, you may wish to also consider adding Echinacea tablets to their feed "plan". It appears that this natural herb stimulates the natural immune defenses to help ward off a chronic infection, especially if the dog is stressed, has undergone recent immunizations, or has a compromised immune system. This herb is NOT recommended for long-term therapy...a plan of 2 weeks of the daily tablets then 2 weeks off has been suggested by some veterinarians. IF your dog has allergies as the basis for the chronic ear irritation, then Echinacea may not be advisable as allergies can be a manifestation of TOO MUCH immune function rather than a suppressed immune system.

Final Comment: Ear infections are an immediate health problem. Do not postpone treatment. And if in doubt, contact your veterinarian for treatment.

A JOKE A DAY

--YOU KNOW YOU'VE WAITED TOO LONG TO FIND A MATE WHEN:

- you think nothing about discussing studs and bitches in a fancy restaurant.
- the first thing you notice about a guy is what breed of dog he has.
- your only nice jewelry features either dogs, dumbbells, paw prints or rosettes.
- when you talk about "scoring" you mean how you did at last weekend's obedience trial.
- your dog has more letters after his name than the last ten guys you've dated, and actually completed obedience school.
- your mother's worst fear is you'll get married and your dog will be in the wedding party.
- you actually have friends whose dogs HAVE been part of the wedding party.
- all of your friends always include your dog in any invitation they issue to you.
- when someone mentions single bars, you wonder if they are talking about utility or agility jumps.
- you once made earrings out of old rabies tags, and all your friends wanted a pair.

The GSD Breed Standard *(continued)*

The German Shepherd Dog Breed Standard is a guideline for every breed fancier to use, study, and commit to memory. Subsequent issues of the *Wag 'N Tongue* will have continued illustrations of other sections of our breed's standard.

Proportion: The German Shepherd Dog is longer than tall, with the most desirable proportion as 10 to 8½. The desired height for males at the top of the highest point of the shoulder blade is 24 to 26 inches; and for bitches 22 to 24 inches. The length is measured from the point of the posternum or breastbone to the rear edge of the pelvis, the ischial tuberosity.

Body: The whole structure of the body gives an impression of depth and solidity without bulkiness. **Chest** - Commencing at the posternum, is well filled and carried well down between the legs. It is deep and capacious, never shallow, with ample room for lungs and heart, carried well forward, with the posternum showing ahead of the shoulder in profile. **Ribs** - Well sprung and long, neither barrel shaped nor too flat, and carried down to the sternum which reaches to the elbows. Correct ribbing allows the elbows to move back freely when the dog is at a trot. Too round causes interference and throws the elbows out; too flat or short causes pinched elbows. Ribbing is carried well back so that the loin is relatively short. **Abdomen** - Firmly held and not paunchy. The bottom line is only moderately tucked up in the loin.

Topline: **Withers** - The withers are higher than and sloping into the level back. Back - The back is straight, very strongly developed without sag or roach, and relatively short. The desirable long proportion is not derived from a long back, but from over-all length with relation to height, which is achieved by length of forequarter and length of withers and hindquarter, viewed from the side. **Loin** - Viewed from the top, broad and strong. Undue length between the last rib and the thigh, when viewed from the side, is undesirable. **Croup** - Long and gradually sloping. **Tail** - Bushy, with the last vertebra extended at least to the hock joint. It is set smoothly into the croup and low rather than high. At rest, the tail hags in a slight curve like a saber. A slight hook, sometimes carried to one side, is faulty only to the extent that it mars general appearance. When the dog is excited or in motion, the curve is accentuated and the tail raised, but it should never be curled forward beyond a vertical line. Tails too short, or with clumpy ends due to ankylosis, are serious faults. A dog with a docked tail must be disqualified.

Hindquarters: The whole assembly of the thigh, viewed from the side, is broad, with both upper and lower thigh well muscled, forming as nearly as possible a right angle. The upper thigh bone parallels the shoulder blade while the lower thigh bone parallels the upper arm. The metatarsus (the unit between the hock joint and the foot) is short, strong and tightly articulated.

Happy Birthday!

August

Tom LaBruyere
Shannon Murphy
Karen Hynek

September

October

Lois O'Connor
Margaret O'Neill
Helen Rockman
Angela Mills
Gail Rutter
Megan Rutter

Please let me know when your birthday is if I've missed you!

Editor Notes

Welcome to New Members, Philip and Helen Abbott; and John, Lisa, Crystal, and Jesse Thompson

When club members don't attend club meetings, we miss them. If you haven't been to a meeting in a while, send me a note and I'll give the members an update.

I so enjoyed seeing Bud Leistner at our July 25th meeting. It's been a long time....too long, Bud! I hope this becomes another bad habit for you (joke!) to become a regular at our meetings once again!*

If you would like an article published in the *Wag* for education, for health, have brags or litters, or other suggestions, please let me know.

Members who would prefer having the newsletter e-mailed, please send me permission at ruttergsd@socket.net or call (573) 324-2240 or (573) 470-3505. Also, Bill Harper will be putting it on the club's website. If you would prefer to view it on the website or print a copy for yourself there, this would save the club the cost of printing and postage. Please let me know if an alternate method of delivery would be permissible.

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Gail Rutter, Editor

PLEASE NOTE:

Barb Gambill's phone number is 314-604-7429, a correction to the roster.

Ilona Horn and Judy DeRousse have volunteered to provide refreshments for the September meeting.

NOTICE-CHANGES

The Annual Picnic will be held on August 31st in lieu of a regular meeting. There will be no board meeting.

The September Meeting will be held on Friday, September 26 , 2008. Please note the change in the Sept Meeting Date. *Board Meeting: 7 pm*

NOTICE-CHANGES

Gail Rutter, Newsletter Chairman
20983 Pike 307
Bowling Green, MO 63334